

MOUNTAIN

Tadasana

This **standing pose** is essentially the anatomical position. It represents how you hold yourself in the world—your postural alignment. The pose creates a stable connection to the earth. Many muscles are slightly engaged to support you upright, resisting gravity.

THE BIG PICTURE

Although the aim is to activate as few muscles as little as possible, a lot of muscles in your body engage subtly in a neutral or lengthening position to prevent you from leaning or falling in any direction. Your lower legs, thighs, hips, back muscles, and abdominals may all be felt buzzing with this slight engagement.

Torso

Your **spinal extensors** and **transversus abdominis** engage to lengthen and stabilize your spine. Your **rhomboids** and middle and lower **trapezius** engage to stabilize your scapulae. Your **pectoralis minor** may be engaging to lift your ribs.

Neck

Your **cervical extensors** engage while in a lengthened or neutral position to keep your neck long with a neutral, inward curve.

Arms

Your **posterior deltoids** slightly engage to externally rotate your shoulders, while your **anterior deltoids** stretch. Your **supinators** engage to make your palms face forward.

